

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Meatball Sandwiches

with Tomato-Cream Sauce, Mozzarella, and Pesto

Italian meatball subs rank pretty high on our list of all-time sandwich greats. This version is our favorite one yet, with all the essentials: tender roasted meatballs, red sauce, and plenty of mozzarella. We add a splash of cream to enrich the marinara as it simmers, then drizzle over pesto after baking for a one-two sauce punch.

35–45 minutes 1120 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 1 yellow onion
- 2 cloves garlic
- 4 demi-baguettes
- ½ cup panko breadcrumbs
- 1½ pounds ground beef
- 2 cans crushed tomatoes
- 2 ounces grated Parmesan cheese
- 1 ounce heavy cream
- 4 ounces shredded mozzarella cheese
- 3 tablespoons pesto

You'll need

- olive oil
- 2 eggs
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- aluminum foil
- baking sheet
- 12" large pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Enlist a helper to **mix and shape the meatballs** (without overmixing) in Step 2, **add the cheese** in Step 5, and **drizzle over the pesto** in Step 6.

If your meatball sandwiches don't stand upright after filling, try leaning them against each other so they hold each other up.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F (see recipe tip). Peel **onion** and finely chop. Mince **garlic**. Slice **baguettes** open horizontally, if they arrived whole, keeping 1 edge intact. Line a baking sheet with foil.



2. Form and bake meatballs

In a large bowl, combine **breadcrumbs**, **¼ cup onion**, **half of garlic**, **2 eggs**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Pat **beef** dry with a paper towel and add to bowl. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 12 equal balls, about 2 inches thick. Arrange **meatballs** on prepared baking sheet, spacing apart as much as possible. Bake until slightly browned and cooked through, 15–18 minutes.



3. Make tomato-cream sauce

While meatballs bake, heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **remaining onion** and **remaining garlic**; sauté, stirring, until softened, 3–4 minutes. Add **crushed tomatoes**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Cook, stirring occasionally, until sauce is thickened and flavors have melded, 6–7 minutes. Remove pan from heat; stir in **Parmesan** and **cream** to combine.



4. Assemble sandwiches

Once baked, carefully halve **meatballs** on sheet (so they fit in the sandwiches). On a clean, dry surface, arrange **baguettes** cut-side up. Spread **half of tomato-cream sauce** inside baguettes, dividing evenly (save remainder for the next step). Add **6 meatball halves** to each baguette. Discard foil from sheet and add **sandwiches** (see recipe tip).



5. Bake meatball sandwiches

Spoon **remaining tomato-cream sauce** over meatballs in baguettes, then sprinkle over **mozzarella**. Bake until cheese is melted and baguettes are golden, 5–6 minutes. (This is a great time to get ahead on dishes.)



6. Plate meatball sandwiches

Once sandwiches are baked, drizzle over **pesto**. Halve **meatball sandwiches** crosswise and divide among serving plates. Dig in!

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